GOOGLE SHEETS TEMPLATE · ALSO WORKS IN EXCEL

Holiday Hidden Cost Tracker

Your gift budget, and what the holidays will still cost you in January. Gifts, pay-in-4 and store financing, and free trials, in one place.

JANUARY
what's due
from every holiday plan, month by month

REAL APR
worked out
from just the payment and the price

FREE TRIALS
cancel-by
date and countdown for each trial

FROM THE EXAMPLE ROWS

Gift budget	$1,500 planned, $1,734 spent	$234 over	OVER
Game console	6 × $89.50 on a $499 console	25.7% APR	HIGH
4K TV	12 × $59 on a $649 TV	16.4% APR	CHECK
Smart watch	pay-in-4, first payment at checkout	0.0% APR	OK
January	all holiday plans together	$428.25 due	

STEP 1 · GET YOUR OWN COPY

OPEN MY TRACKER →

docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1wxzEeO6fx0MqJOv0SrB6MLGLvvn0hh80Hj-1qJ8dajQ/copy

Click the button, then choose **Make a copy**. The copy is yours, saved in your own Google Drive. Nobody else can see what you enter, including us.

HOW IT WORKS

Ready in about ten minutes

1

Make your copy

Open the link on page 1 while signed in to Google and press **Make a copy**.

2

Settings

Enter your holiday budget, your monthly take-home pay and the first month to plan (usually December).

3

Add gifts & plans

One row per person on **Gift List**, one row per payment plan on **Holiday Payments**. Example rows are made up: overwrite or delete them.

Colour code

Columns with a **GOLD header** are yours to fill in. Columns with a **BERRY header** calculate themselves: leave them alone.

On your phone

Install the free Google Sheets app and open the copy from your Drive. Dark mode looks washed out? Tap ⋮ › **View in light theme**.

Prefer Excel?

In your Google copy choose File › Download › Microsoft Excel (.xlsx). Everything calculates. Tick boxes turn into TRUE/FALSE cells.

Please don't "Request edit access"

The link opens a view-only master. Always use **Make a copy** so you have a file you can edit.

WHAT'S INSIDE

Seven tabs, one holiday budget

Dashboard	Budget, spent, left, gifts sorted. What your holiday plans charge next month and the month after, highest real APR, trials ending soon, a month-by-month chart, and what's still to buy.
Gift List	Recipient, relationship, gift, budget, actual cost, paid with, status. Gifts bought on a plan are marked.
Holiday Payments	Price, payment, number of payments, every 2 weeks or monthly, first payment date. Works out total, extra cost, real APR, last payment and what each plan charges in each month.
Deal Check	Before you buy: sale price vs the usual price, the total at checkout with tax and shipping, what a payment plan adds, and a verdict for each item.
Free Trials	Holiday streaming and shipping trials: cancel-by date, countdown and yearly cost if you keep it.
Settings	Budget, income, first month to plan, APR levels for the flags.
How to Use	These instructions, inside the sheet.

Why January matters

Pay-in-4 and store financing split one price into small payments, and several small plans tend to land in the same months. The tracker adds them up so you can see January's total before you check out.

What the flags mean

HIGH real APR at or above 20%. CHECK at or above 10%. OK little or no extra cost, still a bill to plan for. You can change the levels in Settings.

0% store offers can charge back-dated interest if a payment is late or the balance isn't cleared in time: check your agreement.

QUESTIONS

FAQ

Is my information private?

Yes. Your copy lives in your own Google Drive. We never see it, and nothing is sent anywhere.

Dates or months show in another language.

File › Settings › Locale, pick your country. Dates and currency follow it.

My currency isn't dollars.

Select the money columns and choose Format › Number › Currency (or Custom currency). The maths stays the same.

I overwrote a formula by mistake.

Use Undo, or open the link on page 1 again and make a fresh copy.

Already have Hidden Cost Tracker?

This is its holiday edition: same "real cost" maths, built around gifts and the January bills.

Estimates only, not financial, legal or tax advice. Real APR is estimated from your payment schedule and does not include fees charged separately; your agreement is the final word. For personal use only: please don't share or resell the template link.